THE PHOTO EDITION

OMAHA · OCT 11–17, 2026

El Puente

The 2026 NLPOA Omaha National Training Conference & Convention, in pictures

460 photographs

14 stories

7 days, **2** cities

From the **send-off** to the **gala**

One week, one association, four hundred and sixty pictures.

This is the story of El Puente, the 2026 NLPOA national conference and convention, told the way the people who were there will remember it: in photographs.

It follows the week in order, from a send-off in New Orleans to the last group photo at the awards gala in Omaha. It opens with the eighteen members honored with 2026 national awards. Then each chapter tells a short story about the place or event, followed by every photo taken there.

Forging resilient leaders

EMPOWERING COMMUNITIES

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Tap a chapter to turn straight to it.

PHOTOGRAPHY

Chris Martinez
NLPOA Denver Metro Chapter

Sulema Walden
NLPOA Dallas County Chapter

PRODUCED BY

Robyn Garivey Contreras
NLPOA National Secretary

Leibo David Raibstein-Peralta
NLPOA National Editor

2026 The Honorees

Eighteen members recognized with the association's 2026 national awards, for bravery, service and a lifetime of commitment.

2	OFFICER OF THE YEAR
2	MERITORIOUS AWARD
1	LATINA OF THE YEAR
1	COMMUNITY SERVICE EXCELLENCE AWARD
12	LIFETIME MEMBERSHIP AWARD

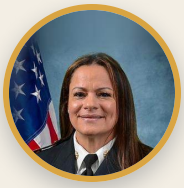
Roll of honor

Steven DeJesus
OFFICER OF THE YEAR
p. 6

Miguel Rivera
OFFICER OF THE YEAR
p. 7

Christian Robinson
MERITORIOUS AWARD
p. 8

Michael Valladarez
MERITORIOUS AWARD
p. 9



Mariluz Santana
LATINA OF THE YEAR
p. 10

Jose Gomez
COMMUNITY SERVICE EXCELLENCE
p. 11

Yolanda Morales
LIFETIME MEMBERSHIP
p. 12

Gabe Morales
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Denny Borg
LIFETIME MEMBERSHIP
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Tap a name to turn to their page.

Officer of the Year

Steven DeJesus

Officer, New York City Police Department, NY

NLPOA BRONX CHAPTER

MEMBER SINCE 2023

14 – years with the NYPD

Mar 7 – 2026, Gracie Mansion

8 – federal charges filed

> *"Courage under fire."*

Steven DeJesus is a 14-year veteran of the New York City Police Department and a member of the NLPOA Bronx Chapter.

On March 7, 2026, an ISIS-inspired attempted bombing took place outside Gracie Mansion, the official residence of the Mayor of New York City, during a clash between a demonstration and a counterprotest. Two suspects, 18 and 19, had traveled from Pennsylvania and allegedly threw two homemade explosive devices, one of them containing the highly volatile explosive TATP.

Not knowing exactly what was being thrown, Officer DeJesus and Detective Miguel Rivera tackled and arrested one suspect while other officers tackled the second. Neither device detonated. Federal prosecutors later indicted both men on eight charges.

★ ★ ★

Selected as the 2026 NLPOA Officer of the Year for his bravery and commitment to law enforcement excellence.

Officer of the Year

Miguel Rivera

Detective, New York City Police Department, NY

NLPOA BROOKLYN CHAPTER VICE PRESIDENT

MEMBER SINCE 2019

2006 – joined the NYPD

2021 – promoted to Detective

El Barrio – 23rd Precinct, Spanish Harlem

> *"The same cuchifrito on Myrtle and Knickerbocker is the one you'll find here on 104th and 3rd Avenue, in the heart of El Barrio."*

Miguel Rivera is Vice President of the NLPOA Brooklyn Chapter. On March 7, 2026, during the ISIS-inspired attempted bombing outside Gracie Mansion, he and Officer Steven DeJesus tackled and arrested one of the suspects as an improvised explosive device was being thrown.

Of Puerto Rican descent, Rivera was born in 1983 at Manhattan Hospital and raised in Bushwick, Brooklyn. He began his career in 2006 in the 23rd Precinct, Spanish Harlem, with eight years on patrol and three in the Domestic Violence office. As a Neighborhood Coordination Officer he worked closely with the communities of El Barrio, and was promoted to Detective in June 2021. Today he is a Community Affairs Officer.

★ ★ ★

Selected as the 2026 NLPOA Officer of the Year for his bravery and commitment to law enforcement excellence.

Meritorious Award

Christian Robinson

Deputy, Dallas County Sheriff's Office, TX

NLPOA DALLAS COUNTY CHAPTER

MEMBER SINCE 2022

Oct 27 – 2025

3:00 a.m. – on an I-35 overpass

Survived – a fall over the bridge railing

On October 27, 2025, at around 3:00 a.m., Deputy Christian Robinson of the Dallas County Sheriff's Department was outside his patrol vehicle on an I-35 overpass near Harry Hines Boulevard, investigating an earlier crash on the slick roadway.

A pickup truck hydroplaned and slammed into his patrol vehicle, knocking him over the bridge railing and onto the embankment below.

Despite serious injuries, Deputy Robinson stayed conscious and was able to radio for help. He was taken to Parkland Hospital. A detainee in his SUV was evaluated at the hospital and was uninjured, as was the driver of the pickup.

★ ★ ★

Selected by NLPOA National for the Meritorious Award for his outstanding commitment to serve, regardless of the danger involved.

Meritorious Award

Michael Valladarez

Sergeant, Dallas County Sheriff's Office, TX

NLPOA DALLAS COUNTY CHAPTER PRESIDENT

MEMBER SINCE 2010

30 – minutes of lifesaving CPR

No AED – available

3 – rescuers working together

On May 12, 2026, Sgt. Michael Valladarez was traveling to Orlando, Florida. At the airport he saw an older woman in medical distress, her face blue and her chest not moving.

With no AED defibrillator available, he began lifesaving CPR. An off-duty officer from Billings, Montana, whom he had never met, stepped in to help, and Austin Chadwell of the U.S. Army joined the rescue.

Together they kept up life-saving techniques for 30 minutes until the ambulance arrived, and the woman was taken to the hospital emergency room.

★ ★ ★

The NLPOA National Meritorious Award recognizes Michael Valladarez for his outstanding selfless act.

Latina of the Year

Mariluz Santana

Major, Orange County Sheriff's Office, FL

NLPOA FLORIDA STATE PRESIDENT

MEMBER SINCE 2021

1998 – began her career

2001 – Orange County Sheriff's Office

8 – units under her command

> *"As a Hispanic woman, I want to show others — especially young Latinas — that they, too, belong in law enforcement, that their voices matter."*

Mariluz Santana is a Major with the Orange County Sheriff's Office, a member of the NLPOA Central Florida Chapter and the NLPOA Florida State President. She began her career with the Apopka Police Department in 1998 and joined the Sheriff's Office in 2001, serving in divisions from Uniform Patrol and Special Operations to the Office of the Sheriff.

She now commands the Investigative Services Section: Sex Crimes, Domestic Violence, Child Abuse, Missing Persons, Digital Forensics, Forensics, Crime Analysis and the Evidence Unit. She serves on the board of Victim Services of Central Florida.

★ ★ ★

Selected as the 2026 NLPOA Latina of the Year for her law enforcement leadership and her commitment to law enforcement excellence.

Community Service Excellence Award

Jose Gomez

Inspector, Minneapolis Police Department, MN

NLPOA MINNESOTA STATE CHAPTER

MEMBER SINCE 2005

1997 – joined the Minneapolis PD

3rd – Precinct Inspector

PAL – youth diversion

A native of Nebraska, Jose Gomez began his career with the Minneapolis Police Department in 1997. He served in the Narcotics Bureau, the Gang Enforcement Team and the Violent Offenders Task Force, then rose to Sergeant and Lieutenant in the Safe Streets Unit, Internal Affairs and the Community Engagement Team. He has led the Juvenile Outreach and Diversion Program and the Gun Violence Response Unit, and serves as 3rd Precinct Inspector.

He helped establish juvenile diversion programs, including the Police Athletic League, and chaired the NLPOA Cinco de Mayo Committee. During Operation Metro Surge he worked with community organizations, business leaders and media to find solutions for Latino residents.

★ ★ ★

Selected as the NLPOA National Community Service Award recipient for innovative practices, leadership, and making life better for the community he serves.

Lifetime Membership Award

Yolanda Morales

Associate Member

NLPOA SEATTLE CHAPTER

MEMBER SINCE 1994

1994 – NLPOA member since

1st – Seattle board, 1994

Many – board positions

Yolanda Morales has been a member since 1994 and is a long-time supporter of the NLPOA, having served in many board positions as a civilian for the NLPOA Seattle Chapter in Washington.

In 1993 she and Gabe Morales, both members of the Chicano Correctional Workers Association, moved to Seattle. She served as Historian on the first board in 1994, of the group that became the Washington Coalition of Hispanics and Law Enforcement (WACHALE). In 2001 WACHALE merged with the NLPOA, becoming the Seattle Chapter.

★ ★ ★

Selected as a 2026 NLPOA Lifetime Membership Award recipient for her lifetime commitment to the NLPOA.

Lifetime Membership Award

Gabe Morales

Retired Officer, King County Department of Corrections, WA

NLPOA SEATTLE CHAPTER PAST PRESIDENT

MEMBER SINCE 2001

20+ – years, King County

1994 – first board president

2008 – "Best Expert at Keeping Kids Off the Street"

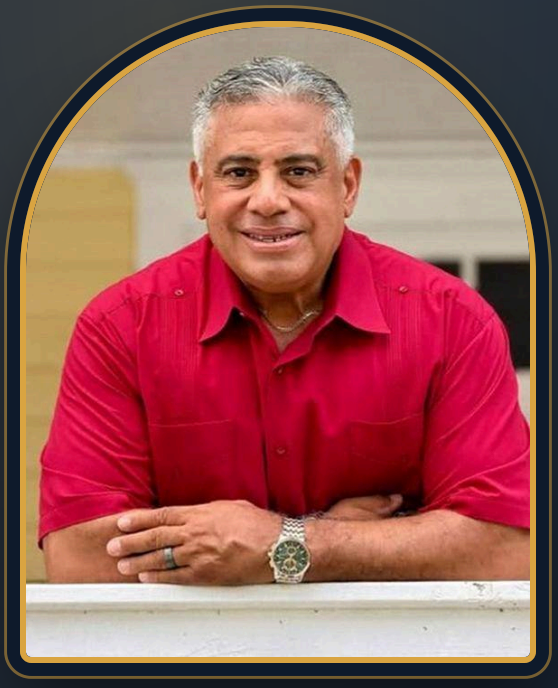
Gabe Morales grew up in Yakima and Seattle. He served four years in the Marine Corps and six years as a Corrections Officer at Folsom State Prison, and worked with youth in Los Angeles group homes and with gang members on probation. At the King County Jail he moved to the Classification Section, where he worked for over 20 years.

He was President of the first 1994 board of the Seattle group that became WACHALE and later merged with the NLPOA. A founder of the International Latino Gang Investigators Association, he has written articles and books on youth crime and gang violence, and joined the Washington Gang Study Group in 2007. Seattle Weekly honored him in 2008, and King County–DAJD gave him a Diversity Award in 2010.

★ ★ ★

Selected as a 2026 NLPOA Lifetime Membership Award recipient for his lifetime commitment to the NLPOA.

Lifetime Membership Award



Michael Garcia

Officer (R), Orlando Police Department, FL

NLPOA CENTRAL FLORIDA CHAPTER

MEMBER SINCE 2001

1994 – joined Orlando PD

1st – Central Florida board

May 20 – 2001, chapter organized

Michael Garcia began his law enforcement career with the Orlando Police Department in 1994 and retired in 2014. He then served with the Mount Dora Police Department until August 2022.

In 2000, Anthony Claudio reached out to him to help start an NLPOA chapter in Central Florida. Garcia helped recruit members and served on the first Central Florida Chapter Board of Directors, alongside Gabi Ortigoni of the Orlando Hispanic Chamber of Commerce, Chamber President Riaza Tomayo, and Lisa Perez of the Orlando Police Department.

He had the courage to help create a sustainable chapter, which was organized on May 20, 2001.

★ ★ ★

Selected as a 2026 NLPOA Lifetime Membership Award recipient for his lifetime commitment to the NLPOA.

Lifetime Membership Award

Anthony Claudio

Court Deputy, Orange County Sheriff's Office, FL

NLPOA CENTRAL FLORIDA CHAPTER

MEMBER SINCE 2001

Founder – Central Florida Chapter

25 – years, Orlando PD

28 – years, U.S. Army

In 2000, Anthony Claudio was an Orlando police officer when the NLPOA Florida State President asked him to start a chapter in Central Florida. Seeing a need to recruit more Hispanics and Latinos into the Orlando Police Department, he reached out to Officer Michael Garcia, Gabi Ortigoni, Riaza Tomayo and Lisa Perez. With vision and courage he built a sustainable chapter, organized on May 20, 2001.

Claudio served with the Orlando Police Department from 1989 to 2014 and is now a Court Deputy with the Orange County Sheriff's Office. He also retired as a Lieutenant Colonel in 2017 after 28 years of active and reserve duty in the United States Army.

★ ★ ★

Selected as a 2026 NLPOA Lifetime Membership Award recipient for his lifetime commitment to the NLPOA.

Lifetime Membership Award

Isaac “Ike” S. De Lugo

Captain (R), Minneapolis Police Department, MN

NLPOA MINNESOTA STATE CHAPTER CO-FOUNDER

MEMBER SINCE 2002

- ***5 → 120*** – members, Minnesota Chapter
- ***33*** – years of service
- ***FBI*** – National Academy graduate

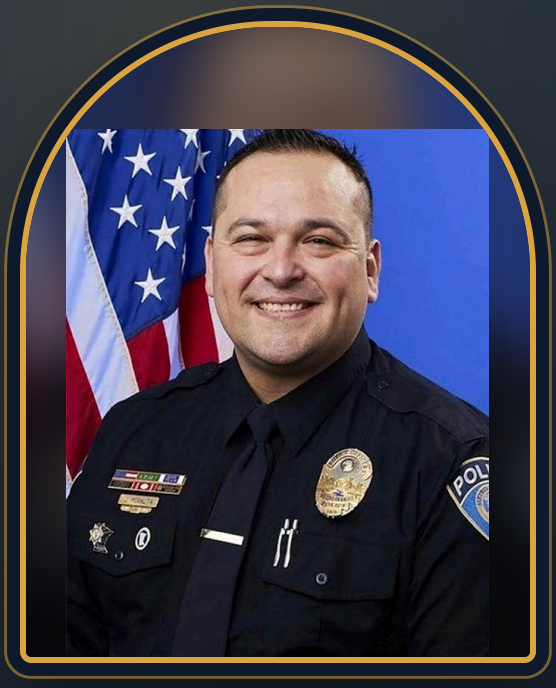
Ike De Lugo began his career in 1979 with the Minnesota National Guard and the Hennepin County Sheriff’s Office, and joined the Minneapolis Police Department in 1983. In 2002 he partnered with fellow trailblazers to establish the NLPOA Minnesota State Chapter, growing it from five members into a network of 120 professionals.

He rose from patrol officer to Lieutenant over the Training Department and Captain of the Juvenile Division, and served as a Hostage Negotiator, Crowd/Riot Control Instructor, Robbery/Homicide Investigator and DEA Task Force Commander. He prepared the 2010 report Reinventing Juvenile Justice, and retired in January 2013 after 33 years.

★ ★ ★

Selected as a 2026 NLPOA Lifetime Membership Award recipient for his lifetime commitment to the NLPOA.

Lifetime Membership Award



Juan Peralta

Officer, Metropolitan Transit Police Department, MN

NLPOA MINNESOTA STATE CHAPTER PAST PRESIDENT

MEMBER SINCE 2006

2006 – joined as a student member

2015 – Metro Transit Police

K9 – EOD handler, Kandahar

Juan Peralta began with the NLPOA in 2006 as a student member. He has served as Minnesota Chapter President and Vice President, Sergeant at Arms, Treasurer and NLPOA National Editor. On the National Board he led a modernization effort: professionalizing publications, strengthening cybersecurity and building platforms that serve members nationwide.

He joined the Metropolitan Transit Police in 2015. His service includes Sarajevo, Bosnia; Tikrit, Iraq, as an Intelligence Analyst; Fort Bragg as an Airborne Paratrooper; Kandahar, Afghanistan, as a K9 Handler (EOD); and Guantanamo Bay, Cuba, as a Military Police Supervisor. He holds a master's in Law Enforcement Leadership from the University of St. Thomas.

★ ★ ★

Selected as a 2026 NLPOA Lifetime Membership Award recipient for his lifetime commitment to the NLPOA.

Lifetime Membership Award

Dr. Eduardo Miranda

Commander (R), Oxnard Police Department, CA

NLPOA VENTURA COUNTY PRESIDENT

MEMBER SINCE 2000

2000 – joined Oxnard PD

2012 – promoted to Commander

USC – doctorate, 2007

Dr. Eduardo Miranda is President of the NLPOA Ventura County Chapter in California, where he has raised thousands of dollars for deserving high school students and led numerous community engagement events.

He joined the Oxnard Police Department in 2000 and was promoted to Sergeant in 2008, Lieutenant in 2010 and Commander in 2012, serving until he retired in 2019. He continues his career as an Investigator with the Ventura County District Attorney's Office.

He earned his bachelor's degree at UC Santa Barbara, a doctorate from the University of Southern California in 2007 and a master's degree from the UCLA School of Law in 2023.

★ ★ ★

Selected as a 2026 NLPOA Lifetime Membership Award recipient for his lifetime commitment to the NLPOA.

Lifetime Membership Award

Mario Molina

Retired Lieutenant, San Francisco Police Department, CA

NLPOA SAN FRANCISCO CHAPTER PRESIDENT

MEMBER SINCE 1996

31 – years with SFPD

Valor – Silver and Bronze Medals

CIT – Crisis Intervention Team lead

Mario Molina is President of the NLPOA San Francisco Chapter and a retired San Francisco Police Lieutenant with 31 years of experience. In his final two years he served as Acting Night Captain, overseeing citywide operations overnight. He led the Crisis Intervention Team Unit and, before that, the Behavioral Science Unit, and investigated hundreds of violent gang-related cases.

Earlier he was a Platoon Commander at Bayview Station, a Gang Task Force and Major Crimes Investigator, and before SFPD a Probation Officer. His honors include the SFPD Silver and Bronze Medals of Valor and the U.S. Attorney General Distinguished Service Award.

★ ★ ★

Selected as a 2026 NLPOA Lifetime Membership Award recipient for his lifetime commitment to the NLPOA.

Lifetime Membership Award

Greg Gonzalez

Director, Douglas County 911 Communications, NE

NLPOA VICE PRESIDENT, NORTHERN REGION (2018–2022)

- ***445+*** – officers in Uniform Patrol
- ***2009–12*** – Nebraska Chapter President
- ***FBI*** – National Academy graduate

Greg Gonzalez began his career in 1993 as a Douglas County Sheriff's Deputy and served the Omaha Police Department from 1995 until he retired as Deputy Chief in 2022. As Deputy Chief of Uniform Patrol he oversaw more than 445 officers, along with Training, Background and Inspections, the Threat Assessment Team and CALEA accreditation. Earlier he supervised homicide detectives as Homicide Unit Sergeant.

In the NLPOA he was Nebraska Chapter President from 2009 to 2012 and National Vice President for the Northern Region from 2018 to 2022. He holds a master's in Public Administration from Bellevue University and a bachelor's from the University of Nebraska at Omaha.

★ ★ ★

Selected as a 2026 NLPOA Lifetime Membership Award recipient for his lifetime commitment to the NLPOA.

Lifetime Membership Award

Mark Matuza

Retired Captain, Omaha Police Department, NE

NLPOA OMAHA CHAPTER

MEMBER SINCE 1993

- ***31*** – years of service
- ***2017*** – promoted to Captain
- ***2×*** – Distinguished Service Award

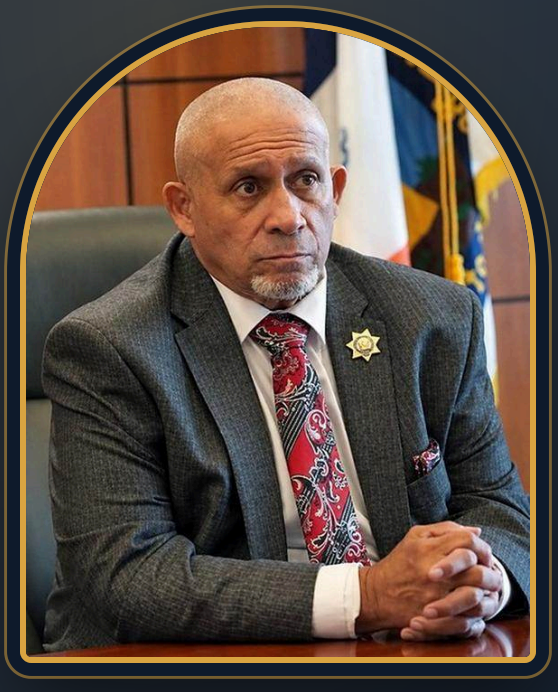
Mark Matuza graduated from Omaha South High School in 1985 and earned a criminal justice degree at the University of Nebraska Omaha. He joined the Omaha Police Department in 1992, rising to Sergeant, Lieutenant and, in 2017, Captain, and retired on December 1, 2023, after 31 years. In 2024 he went back to work part-time in the Mayor's Office.

He has coached youth baseball and football, organized bicycle donations for North Omaha youth, presented at "Teen Talk," and helped organize "Cops and Bobbers" at Benson Park and "Fun in the Park" at Miller Park.

★ ★ ★

Selected as a 2026 NLPOA Lifetime Membership Award recipient for his lifetime commitment to the NLPOA.

Lifetime Membership Award



Carlos Ortiz

Sergeant (R), NYPD School Safety, NY

NLPOA BROOKLYN CHAPTER PRESIDENT

MEMBER SINCE 2004

4 – chapters started or revived

2001–13 – NYPD School Safety

30 – years, NYS Mental Health

In 2004 Carlos Ortiz started the NLPOA School Safety Chapter. He served as New York State Chapter President in 2007 and helped create the New York State Court Officers Chapter that year. In 2018 he reactivated the Bronx County Chapter, sworn in at the national convention in Denver, and in 2019 he started the Greater New York Chapter, now the Brooklyn Chapter, which he leads.

He retired as a Sergeant from the NYPD Division of School Safety, where he worked from 2001 to 2013 as a gang specialist and instructor at its Police Academy. Before that he spent 30 years with the New York State Office of Mental Health.

★ ★ ★

Selected as a 2026 NLPOA Lifetime Membership Award recipient for his lifetime commitment to the NLPOA.

Lifetime Membership Award

Denny Borg

Senior Corporal, Detroit Police Department, MI

NLPOA WAYNE COUNTY/DETROIT CHAPTER

MEMBER SINCE 2005

1996 – joined Detroit PD

2018 – HPOAM Officer of the Year

2003 – NAPO “Top Cop”

Denny Borg joined the Detroit Police Department in 1996 and was promoted to Senior Corporal. He has worked the Sixth Precinct Detective Unit, Michigan HIDTA, the CAGI anti-gang task force building cases for federal and county prosecutors, Organized Crime/Gang Intelligence, and patrol as a Field Training Officer.

His honors include the 2018 Hispanic Police Officers Association of Michigan Officer of the Year, the 2003 NAPO Top Cop certificate, the 2004 Beyond the Badge Community Service Award, the 2002 Spirit of Detroit Award, and a Life-saving Citation.

★ ★ ★

Selected as a 2026 NLPOA Lifetime Membership Award recipient for his lifetime commitment to the NLPOA.

CHAPTER 1 OF 14 · SUNDAY, OCTOBER 11

The send-off

New Orleans, Louisiana

The trip began in New Orleans, Louisiana, the city on the Mississippi River known for its food, its music and the French Quarter.

Before heading north, a little of that Louisiana flavor was packed for the road: two shakers of Cajun seasoning, ready for a week on the Great Plains.

From here the trip ran north to Omaha, Nebraska, home of the 2026 national conference and convention.

1 PHOTO · NEW ORLEANS, LOUISIANA

THE SEND-OFF · NEW ORLEANS, LOUISIANA

Arrival in Omaha

Downtown Omaha

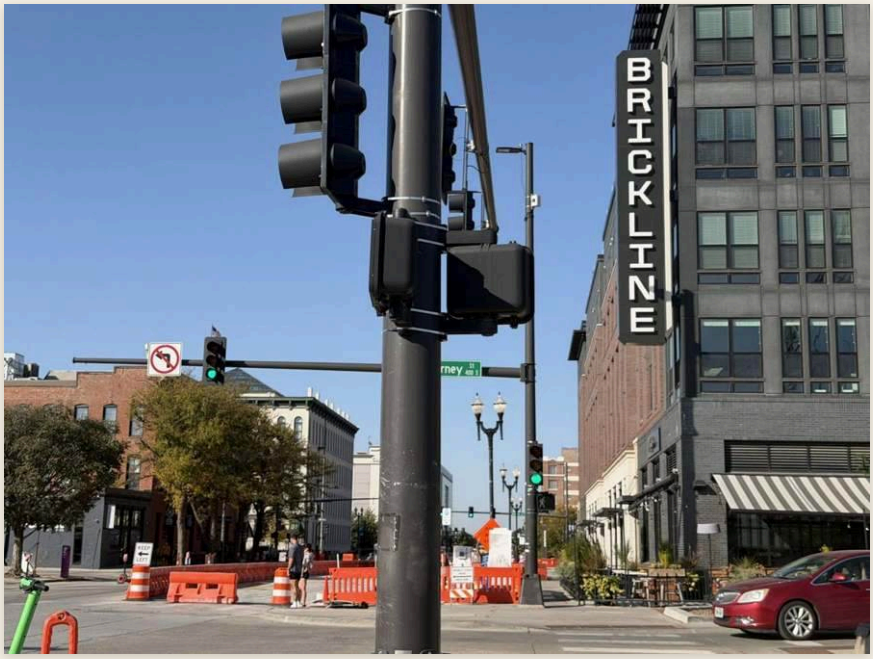
Omaha sits on the Missouri River in eastern Nebraska. Its downtown mixes old brick warehouse buildings with new towers of glass and steel.

On arrival day the sky was clear and blue. The first photos look up at a tall glass tower and the Brickline sign on a downtown corner.

After a long day of travel, the hotel lounge was the place to rest before the week began.

3 PHOTOS · DOWNTOWN OMAHA

ARRIVAL IN OMAHA · DOWNTOWN OMAHA


BRICKLINE

03

CHAPTER 3 OF 14

The calm before

Tuesday, October 13 · Morning
Downtown Omaha

The calm before

Downtown Omaha

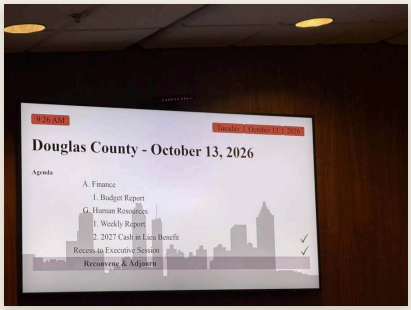
Tuesday morning was quiet in downtown Omaha. Members met in the hotel lobby for the first group photos of the week.

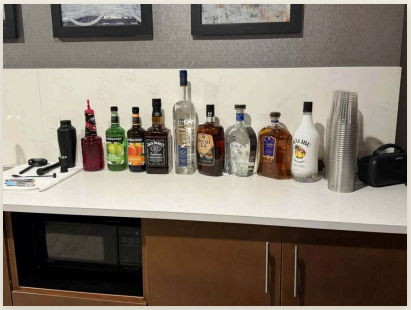
The hospitality suite was set up and stocked for the days ahead.

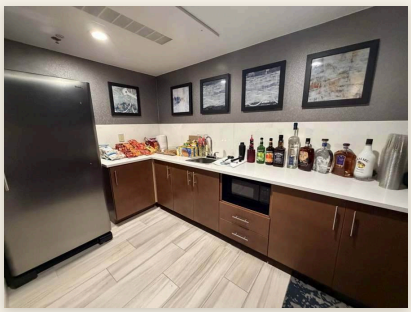
A drive through downtown showed the city under a gray sky: wide streets, the tall tower that anchors the skyline, and a striking black building with sharp angles.

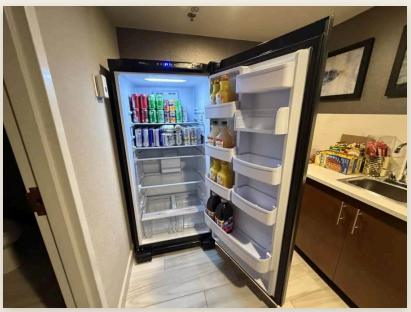
9 PHOTOS · DOWNTOWN OMAHA

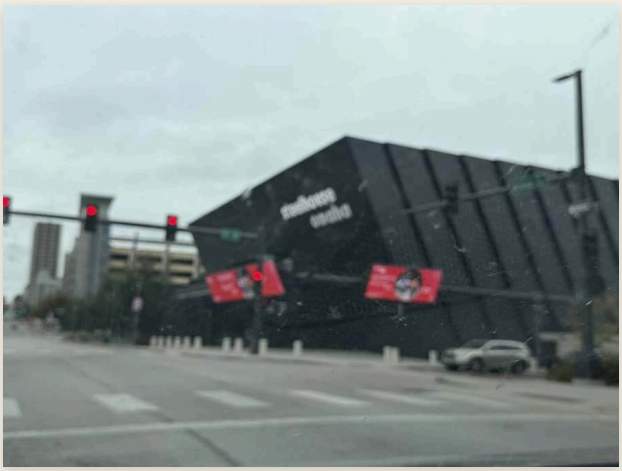
THE CALM BEFORE · DOWNTOWN OMAHA


9:26 AM
Tuesday, 13 October 23 2026
Douglas County - October 13, 2026
Agenda
A. Finance
1. Budget Report
G. Human Resources
1. Weekly Report
2. 2027 Cash in Lieu Benefit
Recess to Executive Session
Reconvene & Adjourn









CHAPTER 4 OF 14

A Maverick welcome

Tuesday, October 13 · Afternoon
University of Nebraska Omaha

A Maverick welcome

University of Nebraska Omaha

The University of Nebraska Omaha is home of the Mavericks. On Tuesday afternoon the group toured its campus.

The tour started by a University of Nebraska police vehicle and the Mavericks mascot statue. It continued through the athletic facilities: a fieldhouse, a competition pool, and a ballpark with seats under a white shade canopy.

Near the ballpark, a sculpture honors Omaha's long history as home of the College World Series. The last stop was the university's hockey arena.

30 PHOTOS · UNIVERSITY OF NEBRASKA OMAHA

OMAHA MAVERICKS
OMAHA SOFTBALL

EMERGENCY 911
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UNIVERSITY OF NEBRASKA

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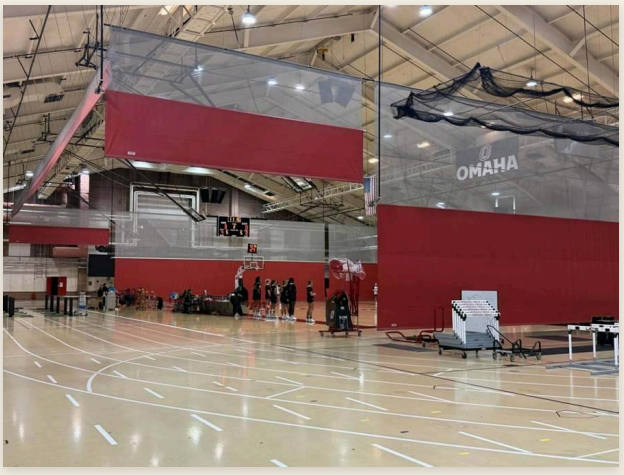
MAVERICKS

MAVERICKS

MAVERICKS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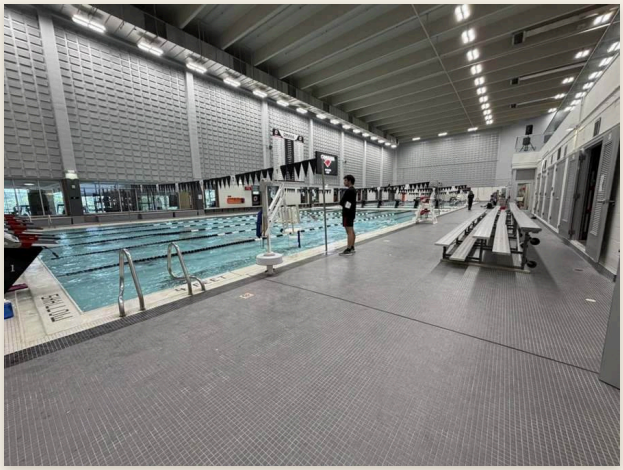
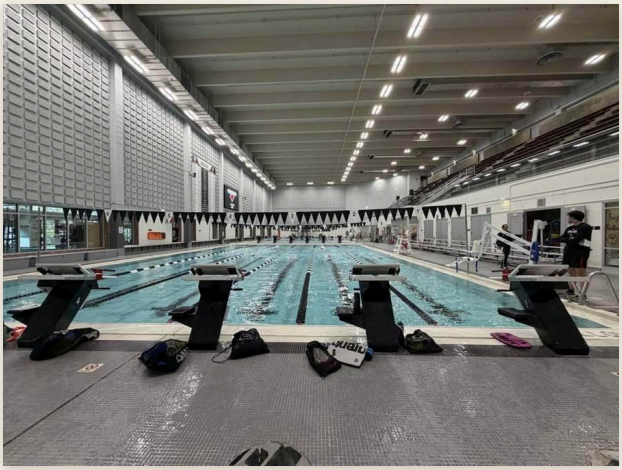
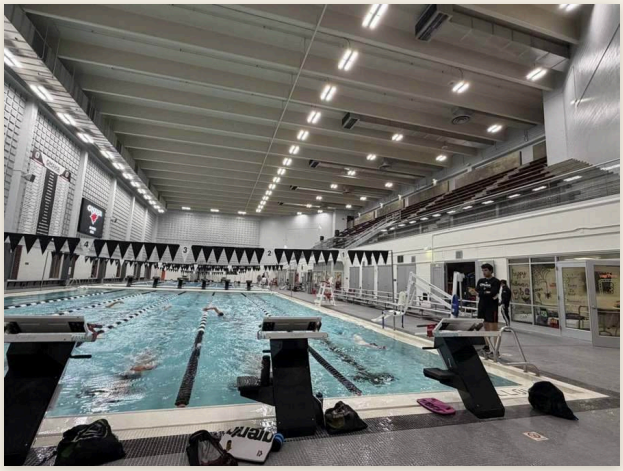
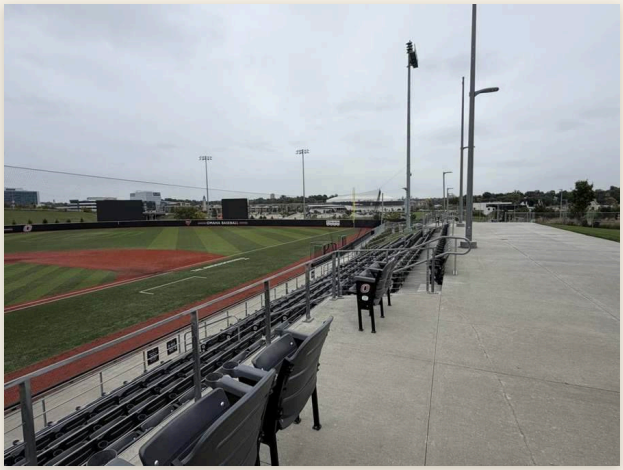




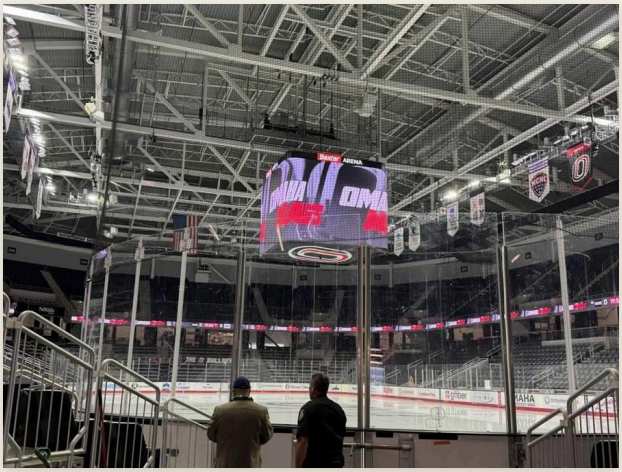


OMAHA SOFTBALL

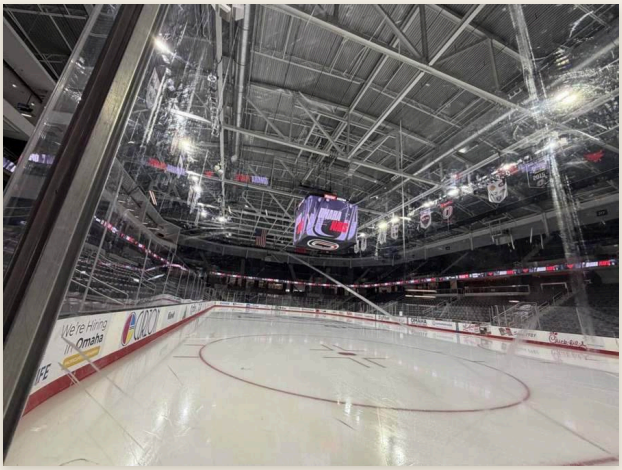
OMAHA MAVERICKS
OMAHA SOFTBALL

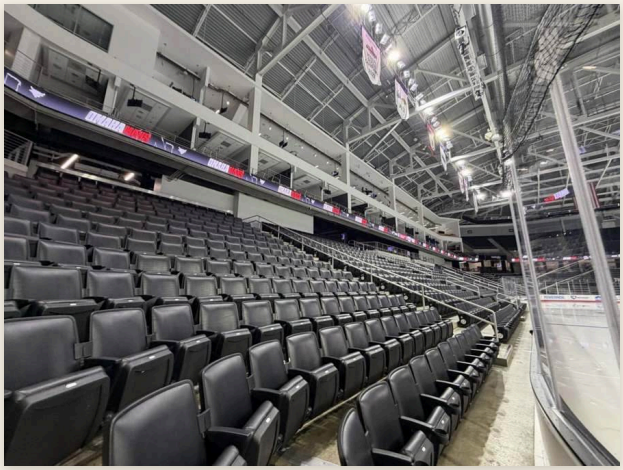


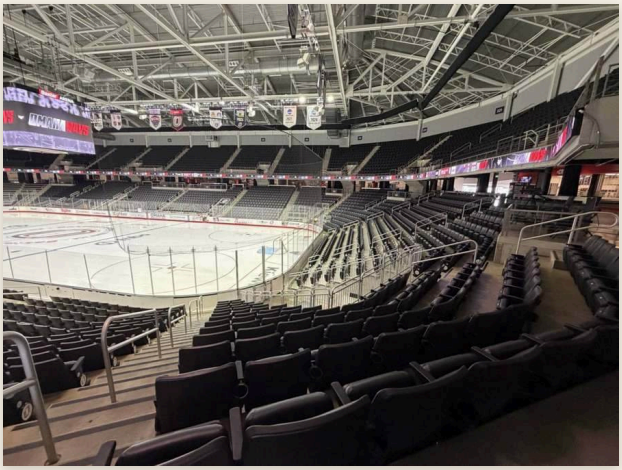
College World Series of Omaha, Inc. – A Hometown Home Run
"The Drive to be a Maverick"
John Lajba, Sculptor
2021

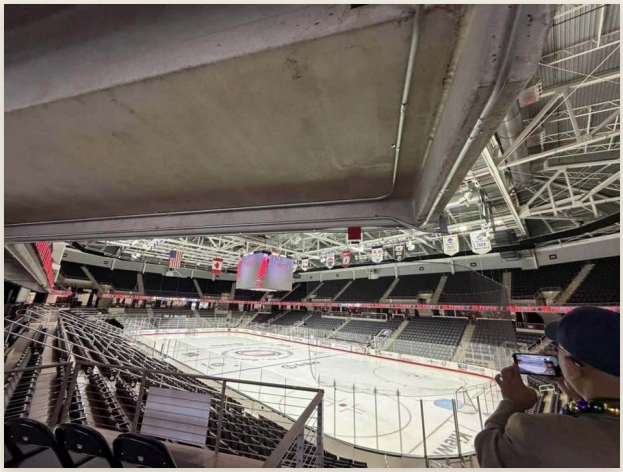


Kewit

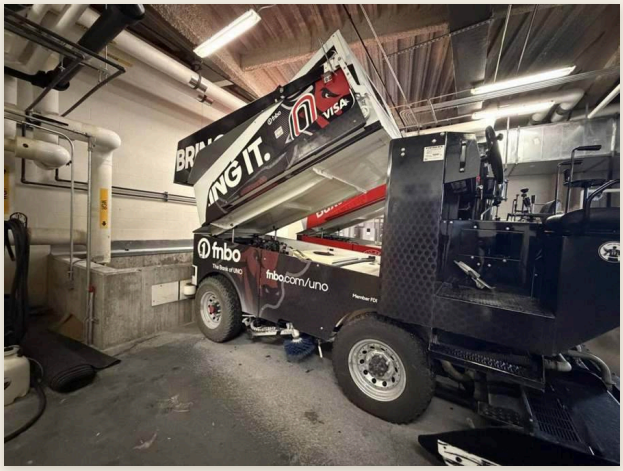

We're Hiring
Omaha







fnbo
The Bank of UNO
fnbo.com/uno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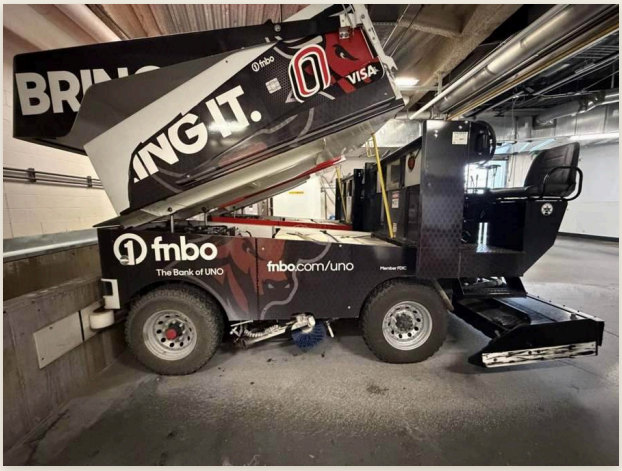
fnbo.com/uno
VISA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The Bank of UNO
fnbo.com/uno
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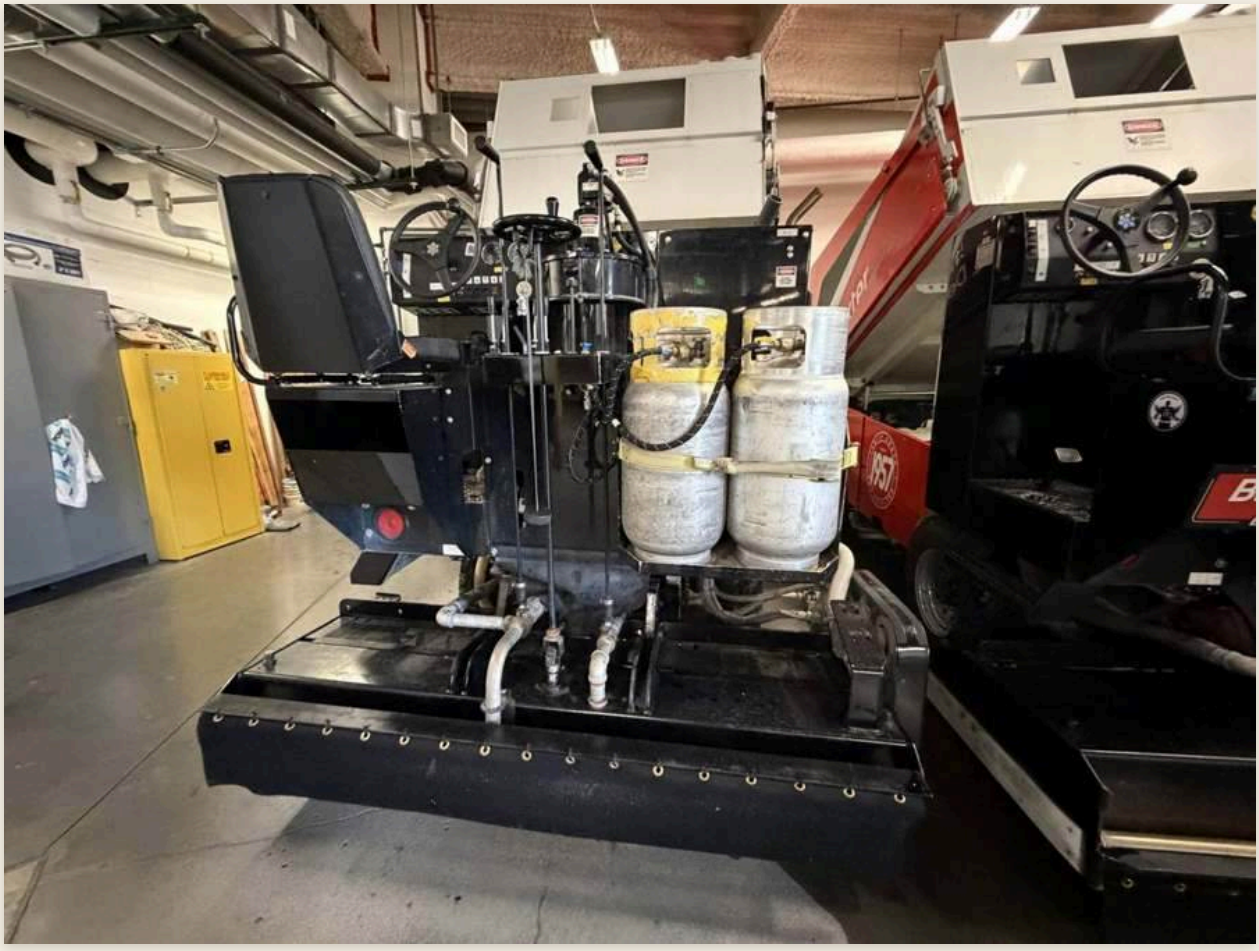


Registration opens

The conference hotel

On Tuesday evening, registration opened at the conference hotel.

The registration desk carried the NLPOA star. Members picked up their credentials and the 2026 convention program, dated October 14th to 17th, 2026.

The table also offered a giveaway raffle from the Texas State Chapter and NLPOA FIFA challenge coins.

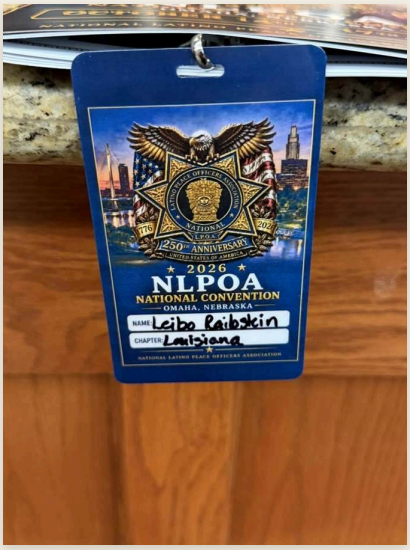
7 PHOTOS · THE CONFERENCE HOTEL

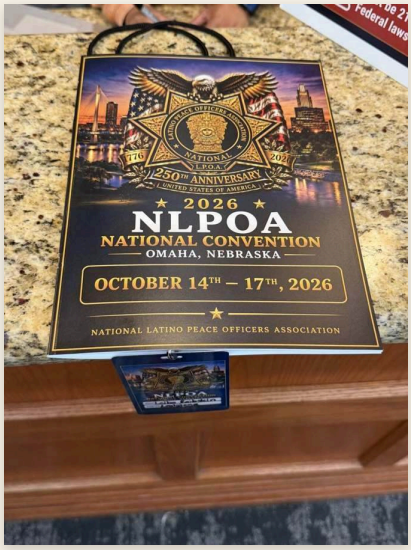
REGISTRATION OPENS · THE CONFERENCE HOTEL

REGISTRATION
SCAN TO REGISTER
THE APP IS
READY
NLPOA EVENTS
GET
STARTED

NLPOA TEXAS STATE CHAPTER
GIVEAWAY
Benefiting the 2026 NLPOA Training Conference & Convention
Sponsored By
$20
EACH TICKET
$100
FOR 6 TICKETS
Tickets can be purchased near the registration table
Winner will be announced during the 2026 Awards Gala.
Must be 21 years or older and must meet all Local, State and Federal laws within the State the winner lives.

NLPOA
FIFA
CHALLENGE COINS
GET YOURS TODAY
JUNE 11 - JULY 19, 2026
$30 EACH COIN
Coins can be purchased near the registration table


2026
NLPOA
NATIONAL CONVENTION
OMAHA, NEBRASKA
NAME Leibo Raibstein
CHAPTER Louisiana


2026
NLPOA
NATIONAL CONVENTION
OMAHA, NEBRASKA
OCTOBER 14TH – 17TH, 2026
NATIONAL LATINO PEACE OFFICERS ASSOCIATION

Opening ceremonies

The conference hotel

On Wednesday the convention officially opened at the conference hotel.

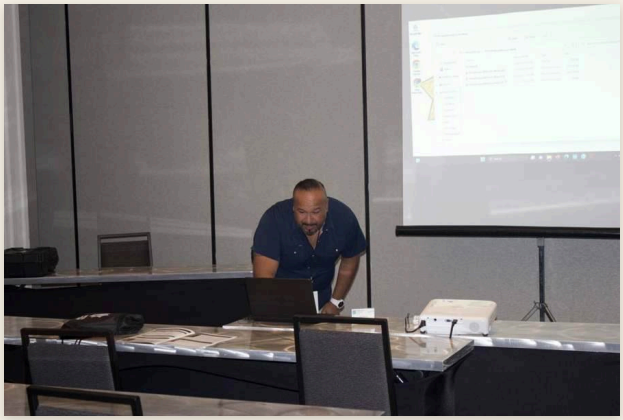
An honor guard presented the colors, and the head table took its place on the stage behind the podium with the NLPOA crest.

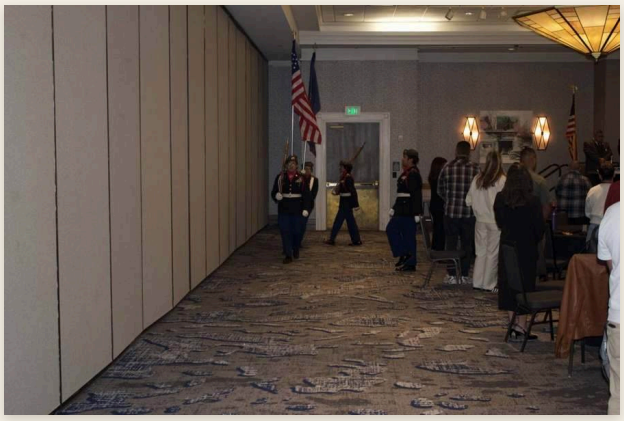
Later that afternoon, a framed display was presented in front of the photo wall.

For the next four days, this hotel was the home of the convention.

25 PHOTOS · THE CONFERENCE HOTEL

OPENING CEREMONIES · THE CONFERENCE HOTEL





A visit to Boys Town

Boys Town, Nebraska

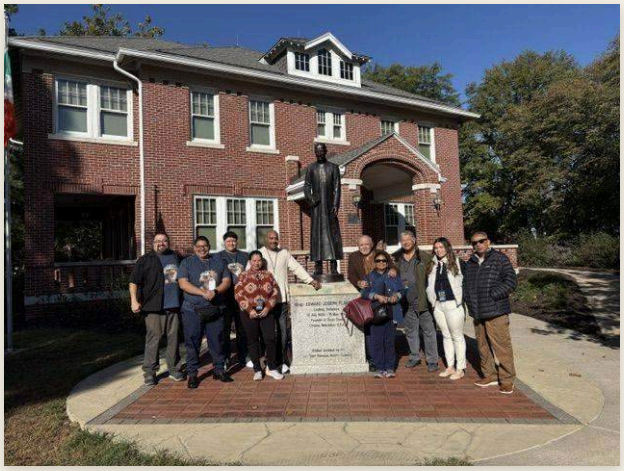
Boys Town is a village just west of Omaha. Father Edward Flanagan founded it in 1917 as a home for boys who had nowhere else to go, and it still cares for children and families today.

The group visited its historic grounds, including a brick house with a statue out front, and the museum, which tells the village's story.

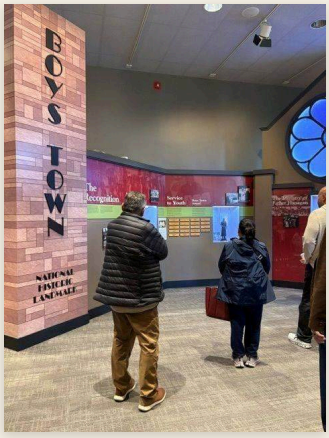
Inside the museum, a vintage Boys Town bus is on display, and the group stopped there for photos.

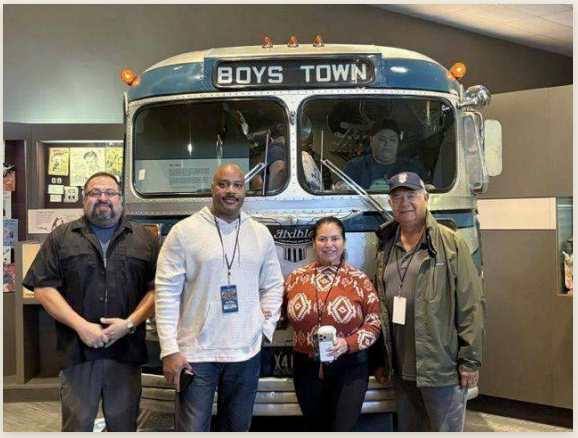
8 PHOTOS · BOYS TOWN, NEBRASKA

A VISIT TO BOYS TOWN · BOYS TOWN, NEBRASKA



SAVING CHILDRE


BOYS TOWN
NATIONAL
HISTORIC
LANDMARK


BOYS TOWN

CHAPTER 8 OF 14

A full house

Thursday, October 15
The conference hotel

A full house

The conference hotel

Thursday was the first full day of the convention at the conference hotel.

The meeting rooms and the main hall filled up, with the head table on stage under the chandeliers. One workshop covered building a peer support team.

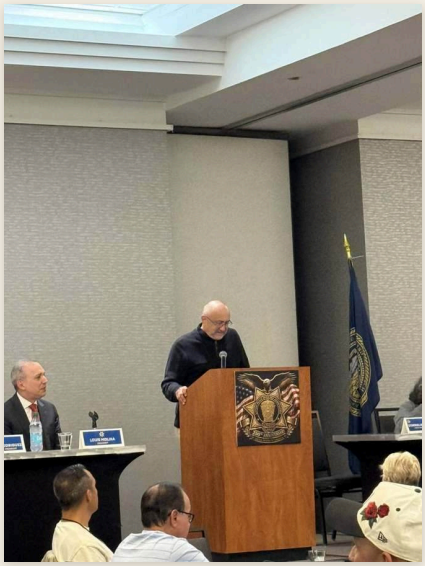
Between sessions, the NLPOA photo wall, a backdrop printed with the association’s crest, was the place for group photos.

63 PHOTOS · THE CONFERENCE HOTEL

A FULL HOUSE · THE CONFERENCE HOTEL

BUILDING A PEER SUPPORT TEA

Goglas
CENTRAL FLORID
CHAPTER



RESERVED

LOUISIANA

LATINO PEACE OFFICERS ASSOCIATION
NATIONAL
L.P.O.A.
1776
2020
250TH ANNIVERSARY
UNITED STATES OF AMERICA

OMAHA

Memorial at dawn

Nebraska Vietnam Veterans Memorial

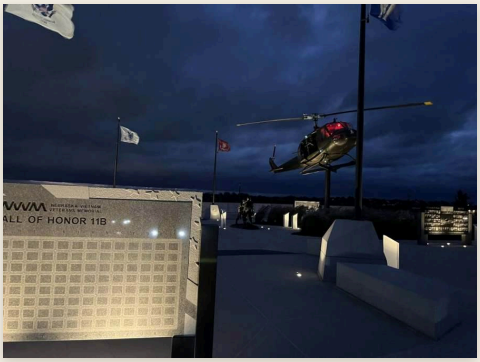
The Nebraska Vietnam Veterans Memorial honors the Nebraskans who served in the Vietnam War. Early Friday, a group visited at first light.

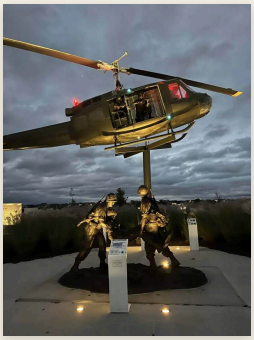
A long wall carries the memorial's name and the emblems of the armed services. A Huey helicopter is mounted high above the grounds. The American flag and the POW/MIA flag fly overhead, beside the Hall of Honor.

Stone markers carry the seals of each military branch. The group walked the grounds and gathered for photos as the day began.

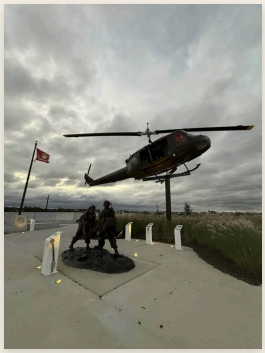
23 PHOTOS · NEBRASKA VIETNAM VETERANS MEMORIAL

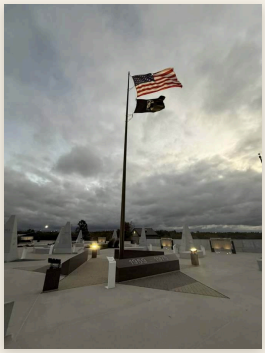
MEMORIAL AT DAWN · NEBRASKA VIETNAM VETERANS MEMORIAL





In honor of 7 Coast Guardsmen killed on the Point Welcome





NEBRASKA VIETNAM
VETERANS MEMORIAL

NEBRASKA VIETNAM
VETERANS MEMORIAL

NEBRASKA VIETNAM
VETERANS MEMORIAL

NEBRASKA VIETNAM
VETERANS MEMORIAL

Friday at the hotel

The conference hotel

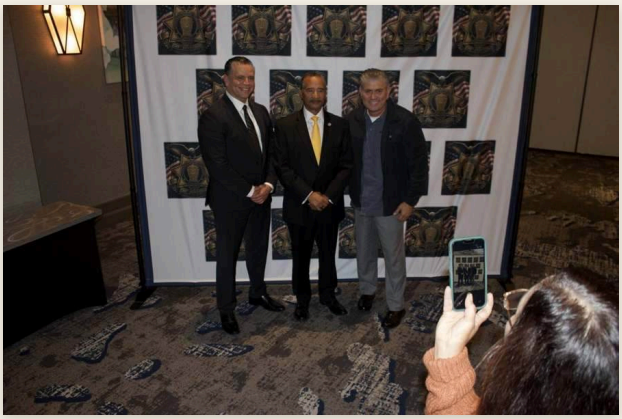
On Friday the convention continued at the conference hotel.

The meeting rooms filled again, and the stage in the main hall stayed busy all day.

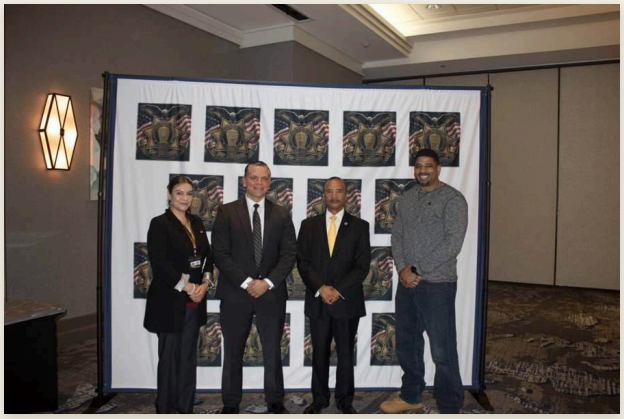
The photo wall drew a crowd once more as chapters and friends lined up for pictures.

46 PHOTOS · THE CONFERENCE HOTEL

FRIDAY AT THE HOTEL · THE CONFERENCE HOTEL



¡ola!



11

CHAPTER 11 OF 14

Dinner downtown

Friday, October 16 · Evening
Downtown Omaha

Dinner downtown

Downtown Omaha

On Friday night the group had dinner together at a restaurant in downtown Omaha.

The restaurant has exposed brick walls, arched windows and warm, low lighting. Everyone sat together at one long table.

It was the last free evening before Saturday’s convention business and gala.

2 PHOTOS · DOWNTOWN OMAHA

DINNER DOWNTOWN · DOWNTOWN OMAHA

12

CHAPTER 12 OF 14

Convention day

Saturday, October 17 · Morning
The conference hotel

Convention day

The conference hotel

On Saturday morning, members met in the main hall of the conference hotel for the annual general business meeting.

One after another, members spoke from the podium with the NLPOA crest.

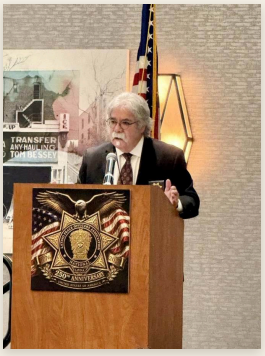
New Orleans presented its bid to host the next national conference, NOLA 27, under the banner “Laissez les bons temps rouler!”

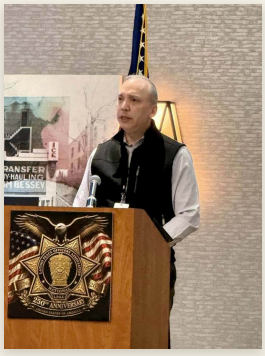
53 PHOTOS · THE CONFERENCE HOTEL

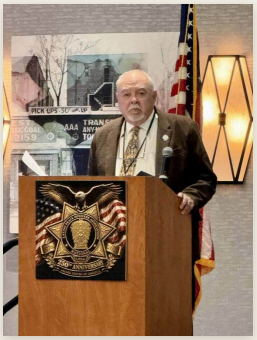
CONVENTION DAY · THE CONFERENCE HOTEL

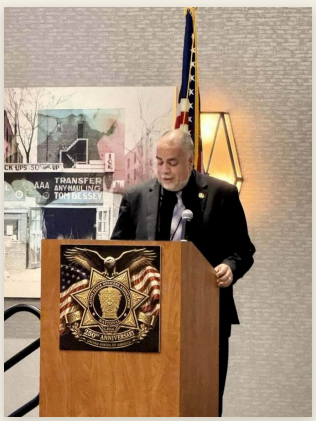
NATIONAL LATINO PEACE OFFICERS ASSOCIATION
Laissez les bons temps rouler!
NOLA 27

WHERE THE BADGE LEADS US









Laissez les bons temps rouler!
NOLA 27

Everyone together

The conference hotel

At midday, everyone gathered in the main hall for the 2026 convention group photo.

Members from chapters across the country filled the frame, row after row, in one room.

1 PHOTO · THE CONFERENCE HOTEL

EVERYONE TOGETHER · THE CONFERENCE HOTEL

The awards gala

The conference hotel

The week ended on Saturday night with the 2026 Formal Awards Gala in the hotel ballroom.

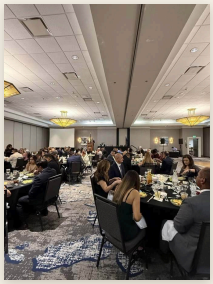
The ballroom was set with round tables and chandeliers. Honorees received awards and certificates, then posed at the photo wall with family, friends and their chapters.

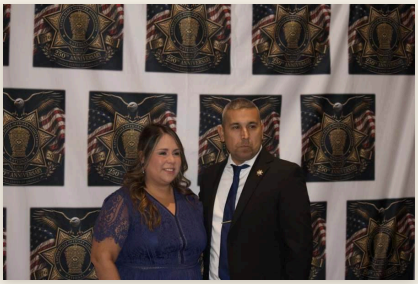
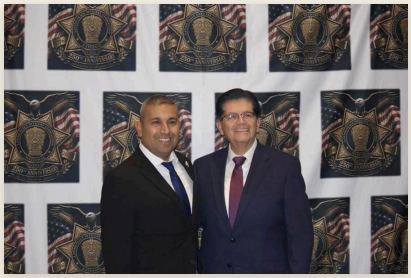
A mariachi band played between courses, and the night ended on the dance floor.

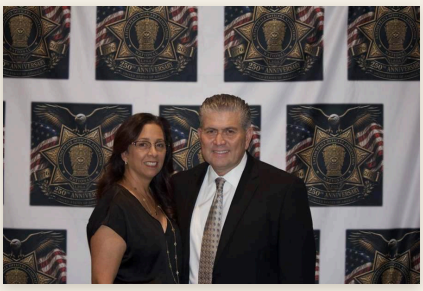
It was the final night of the week in Omaha.

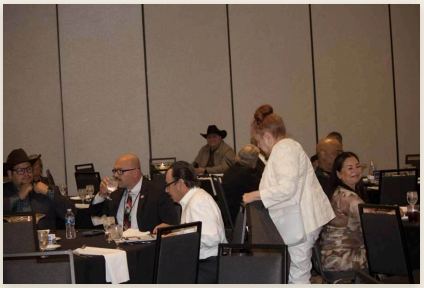
189 PHOTOS · THE CONFERENCE HOTEL

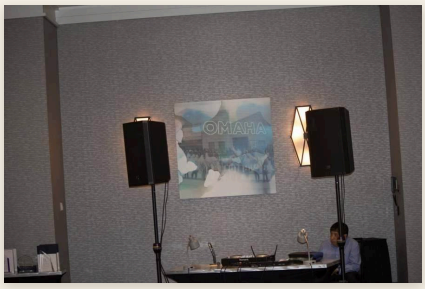
THE AWARDS GALA · THE CONFERENCE HOTEL

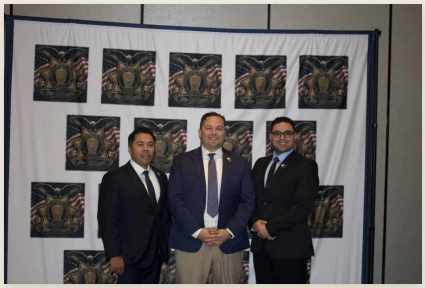


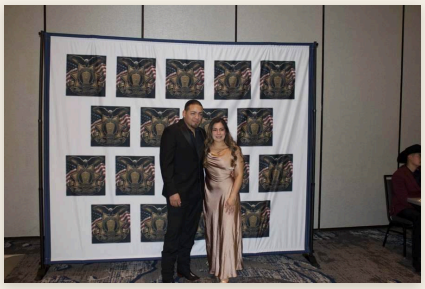



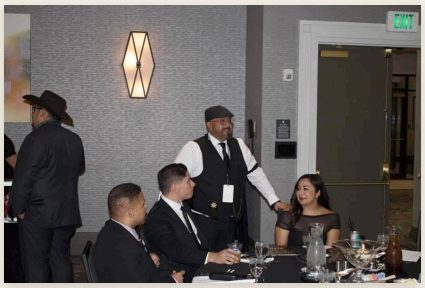


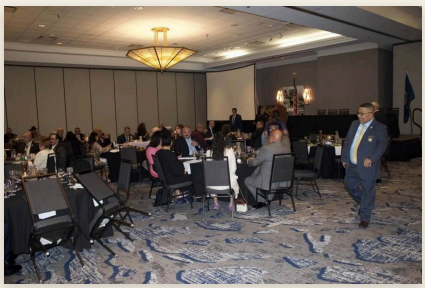


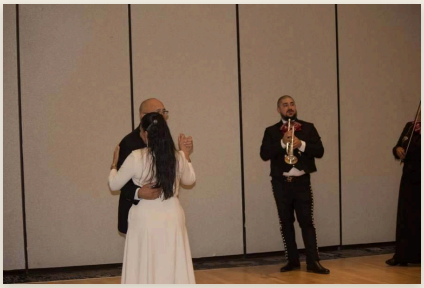

OMAHA

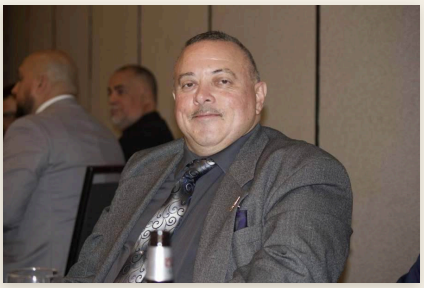
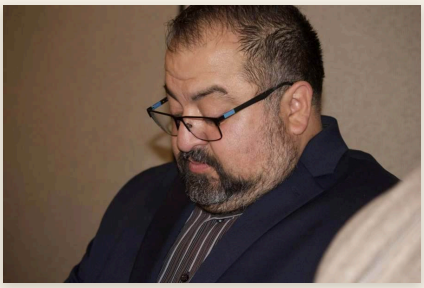





EXIT





Hasta la próxima

See you in New Orleans · NOLA 27

NATIONAL NLPOA

TRAINING CONFERENCE & CONVENTION

OCTOBER 26-30, 2027

NEW ORLEANS, LOUISIANA

Laissez les bons temps rouler!

NOLA 27

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CONTACT CONVENTION CHAIR:
CHIEF JOSÉ A. CAMPUZANO
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